

Supplement-FKG Inequality

- (FKG Inequality I) Let $X_1, \dots, X_n$ be independent random variables, and let f, g be increasing functions of n variables. Then we have

$$\mathbb{E}[f(X_1, \dots, X_n)g(X_1, \dots, X_n)] \geq \mathbb{E}f(X_1, \dots, X_n)\mathbb{E}g(X_1, \dots, X_n)$$

Proof

We do it by induction.

For the case $n = 1$, monotonicity implies

$$[f(x) - f(y)][g(x) - g(y)] \geq 0$$

Take y as an independent copy of X and take expectation and we have derived the result.

Assume FKG inequality holds for all that are no greater than $n - 1$, we now prove it for n .

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[f(X_1, \dots, X_n)g(X_1, \dots, X_n)] &= \mathbb{E}(\mathbb{E}(fg|X_n)) \\ &\geq \mathbb{E}(\mathbb{E}(f|X_n) \cdot \mathbb{E}(g|X_n))\end{aligned}$$

$\mathbb{E}(f|X_n)$ is an increasing r.v. of X_n

Thus

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[f(X_1, \dots, X_n)g(X_1, \dots, X_n)] &\geq \mathbb{E}(\mathbb{E}(f|X_n)) \cdot \mathbb{E}(\mathbb{E}(g|X_n)) \\ &= \mathbb{E}f(X_1, \dots, X_n)\mathbb{E}g(X_1, \dots, X_n)\end{aligned}$$

Now we define increasing events.

Assume there is a partial order in Ω

- For $A \in \mathcal{F}$, we call it an increasing event if $\omega \in A \Rightarrow \omega' \in A, \forall \omega' \geq \omega$

By FKG inequality, we have

- If A, B are increasing events, then

$$\mathbb{P}(AB) \geq \mathbb{P}(A)\mathbb{P}(B)$$

- If A, B are respectively increasing&decreasing events, then

$$\mathbb{P}(AB) \leq \mathbb{P}(A)\mathbb{P}(B)$$

Question: If A, B, C are all increasing, do we have $\mathbb{P}(AB|C) \geq \mathbb{P}(A|C)\mathbb{P}(B|C)$

Solution Our answer is "NO". Here is an counterexample.

Consider a simple Boolean lattice space $\{0, 1\}^2$ where each component is independent and takes the value 1 with probability p . Define:

- **Increasing event** C : At least one component is 1, i.e., $C = \{(0, 1), (1, 0), (1, 1)\}$.
- **Increasing event** A : The first component is 1, i.e., $A = \{(1, 0), (1, 1)\}$.

- **Increasing event B :** The second component is 1, i.e., $B = \{(0, 1), (1, 1)\}$.

Calculations:

1. $P(AB|C)$: The event AB corresponds to $(1, 1)$, with probability p^2 . The conditional probability is:

$$P(AB|C) = \frac{p^2}{2p(1-p) + p^2} = \frac{p}{2-p}.$$

2. $P(A|C)$ and $P(B|C)$: By symmetry, both equal:

$$P(A|C) = \frac{p(1-p) + p^2}{2p(1-p) + p^2} = \frac{1}{2-p}.$$

Thus, their product is:

$$P(A|C)P(B|C) = \left(\frac{1}{2-p} \right)^2.$$

Comparison:

$$\frac{p}{2-p} \geq \frac{1}{(2-p)^2} \Rightarrow p(2-p) \geq 1.$$

For $p = 0.5$, the left side becomes $0.5 \times 1.5 = 0.75 < 1$, which clearly fails. At this value:

- $P(AB|C) = \frac{0.5}{1.5} \approx 0.333$,
- $P(A|C)P(B|C) \approx 0.444$,

This violates the inequality.

Application Let $\mathcal{H}$ be a family of subsets of $[n]$ such that for all $A, B \in \mathcal{H}$, $A \cap B \neq \emptyset$ and $A \cup B \neq [n]$. Then $|\mathcal{H}| \leq 2^{n-2}$.

Proof

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the "upward order ideal" generated by $\mathcal{H}$: $\mathcal{F} = \{S : \exists T \in \mathcal{H}, T \subseteq S\}$. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be the "downward order ideal" generated by $\mathcal{H}$: $\mathcal{G} = \{S : \exists T \in \mathcal{H}, S \subseteq T\}$. Then $\mathcal{H} \subseteq \mathcal{F} \cap \mathcal{G}$.

$|\mathcal{F}| \leq 2^{n-1}$ because $\mathcal{F}$ satisfies the property that $\emptyset \subset A \cap B$ for all $A, B \in \mathcal{F}$, and therefore $\mathcal{F}$ cannot contain any set and its complement.

Likewise, $|\mathcal{G}| \leq 2^{n-1}$ because $\mathcal{G}$ satisfies the property that $A \cup B \neq [n]$ for all $A, B \in \mathcal{G}$, and therefore $\mathcal{G}$ cannot contain any set and its complement.

Interpreting this in terms of the bits being distributed uniformly i.i.d, we have that $\Pr(\mathcal{F}) \leq 1/2$ and $\Pr(\mathcal{G}) \leq 1/2$. Since $\mathcal{F}$ is an increasing event and $\mathcal{G}$ a decreasing event, $\Pr(\mathcal{F} \cap \mathcal{G}) \leq 1/4$.

A generalization of FKG inequality:

- (FKG Inequality II) Let $X_1, \dots, X_n$ be independent random variables. Suppose f_1, f_2, f_3, f_4 are non-negative functions on $\mathbb{R}^n$ satisfying

$$f_1(x)f_2(y) \leq f_3(x \wedge y)f_4(x \vee y)$$

where x, y are n -dimensional vectors and $\wedge$ means taking coordinate-wise minimum and $\vee$ likewise. Then we have

$$\mathbb{E}f_1\mathbb{E}f_2 \leq \mathbb{E}f_3\mathbb{E}f_4$$

- (FKG Inequality III) Suppose $\mathbb{P}$ is a probability measure with density $p = \frac{d\mathbb{P}}{d\mu}$ where μ is a product measure.

Assume $p(x)p(y) \leq p(x \wedge y)p(x \vee y)$. If f, g are increasing and $\mathbb{P} \in L^2$, then we have

$$\mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}}(fg) \geq \mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}}f \cdot \mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}}g$$

- (FKG Inequality IV) Γ is a finite distributive lattice, and μ is a positive measure on Γ satisfying that for all $x, y \in \Gamma$,

$$\mu(x \wedge y)\mu(x \vee y) \geq \mu(x)\mu(y).$$

Then, for all increasing functions f, g on Γ , the inequality $\mathbb{E}(fg) \geq \mathbb{E}f \cdot \mathbb{E}g$ holds.

Application (Ising Model)

We have a finite graph $G = (V, E)$. We define a probability measure on

$$\mathbb{P}(\sigma) = \frac{1}{Z} \exp \left(\beta \sum_{(u,v) \in E} \sigma_u \sigma_v \right)$$

$\forall \sigma \in \{-1, 1\}^V$

where Z is a normalization constant, and $\beta \geq 0$ is a constant relative to temperature.

Question: Does FKG inequality holds for such probability measure?

Solution

We only need to check

$$\mathbb{P}(\sigma)\mathbb{P}(\tau) \leq \mathbb{P}(\sigma \wedge \tau)\mathbb{P}(\sigma \vee \tau)$$

$\forall \sigma, \tau \in \{-1, 1\}^V$

Key calculation:

For each edge (u, v) , the term in the exponent of the density ratio is:

$\sigma_u \sigma_v + \tau_u \tau_v - (\sigma \wedge \tau)_u (\sigma \wedge \tau)_v - (\sigma \vee \tau)_u (\sigma \vee \tau)_v$. When σ and τ differ at both u and v , this term equals -4 , leading to an overall negative contribution to the exponent. For other cases, the term is 0.

The lattice condition holds, which implies FKG inequality also holds for true.

Application (Potts model)

The only difference Potts model from Ising model is $\sigma \in [n]^V$.

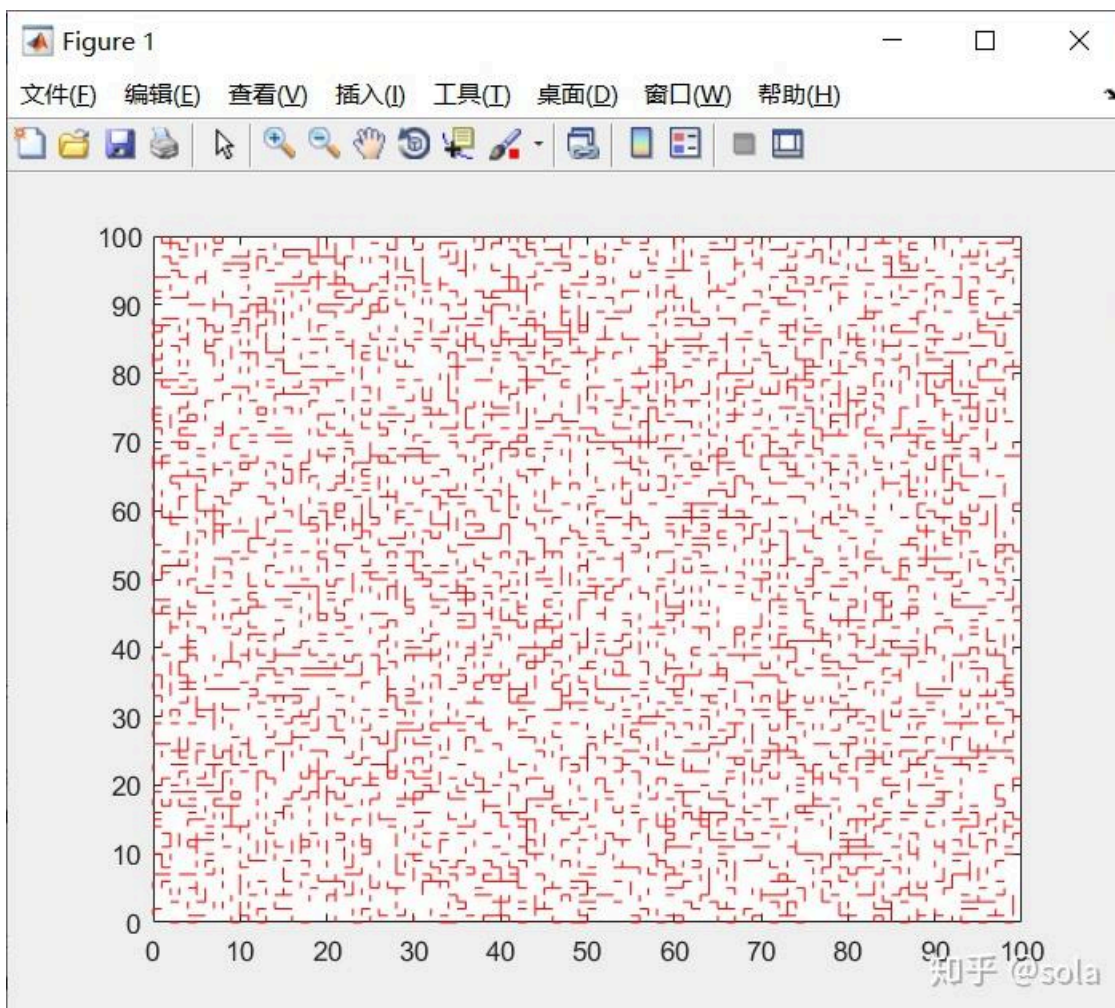
- (FKG Inequality for multivariable Gaussian) If X is multivariable Gaussian with $\Sigma = (\sigma_{ij})$ satisfying $\sigma_{ij} \geq 0$. Then

$$\mathbb{E}[f(X)g(X)] \geq \mathbb{E}f(X) \cdot \mathbb{E}g(X)$$

for increasing functions f, g .

Application (Percolation)

Our model is set on $\mathbb{Z}^d$, let each edge be open with probability p independently.

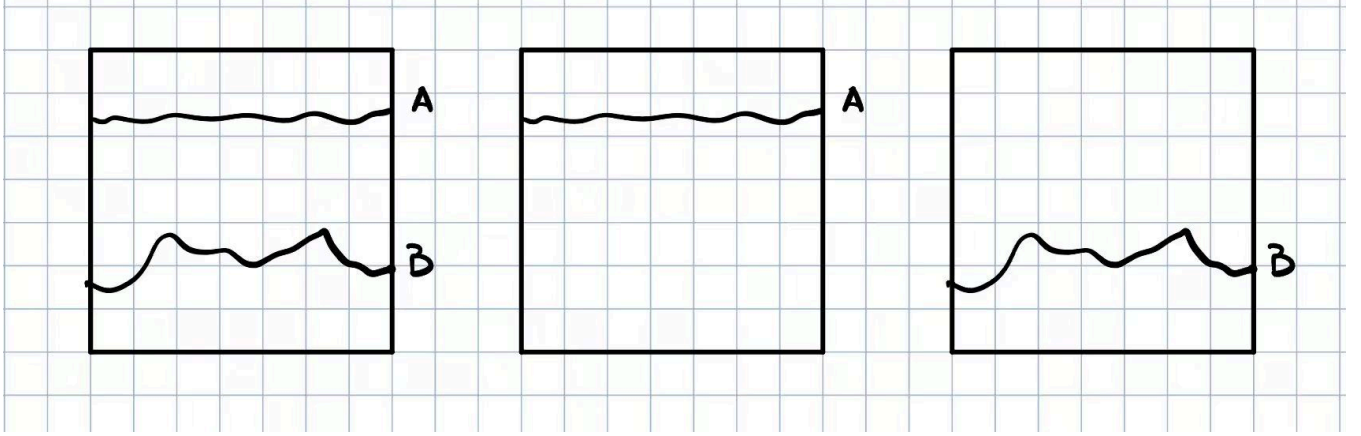


The figure shows an example on $\mathbb{Z}^2$.

And what we care about is the connected component generated by the open edges.

By FKG Inequality, we know that

means a rectangle can be connected from above or below.



Notice: We allow open edges in two parts to be overlapped.

Now we consider another events C : rectangle can be connected from above and simultaneously below with no edges overlapping.

Actually, we have

$$\mathbb{P}(C) \leq \mathbb{P}(A)\mathbb{P}(B)$$

(Intuition: local exploration)

To generalize, we want to construct an inequality that is directionally opposite to the FKG inequality.

Def $S \subset [n]$. An event A occurs on S in configuration w if $w \in A|_S$, where $A|_S = \{\omega : \forall \tilde{w} : \tilde{w} = w \text{ on } S, \text{ we have } \tilde{w} \in A\}$.

Note: Knowing parts of the results on S , whether A occurs can be known.

Def Two events A_1, A_2 occur disjointly, denoted by $A_1 \circ A_2$, if there are two disjoint sets on which they occur:

$$A_1 \circ A_2 = \{\omega : \exists S_1, S_2 \subset [n], \text{ s. t. } S_1 \cap S_2 = \emptyset, \omega \in A_1|_{S_1} \cap A_2|_{S_2}\}$$

- (BKR Inequality) Consider $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \mu)$, where $\Omega = \Omega_1 \times \cdots \times \Omega_n, \mu = \mu_1 \times \cdots \times \mu_n$, then

$$\mu(A \circ B) \leq \mu(A)\mu(B)$$

First, let's see an application of BKR inequality in percolation.

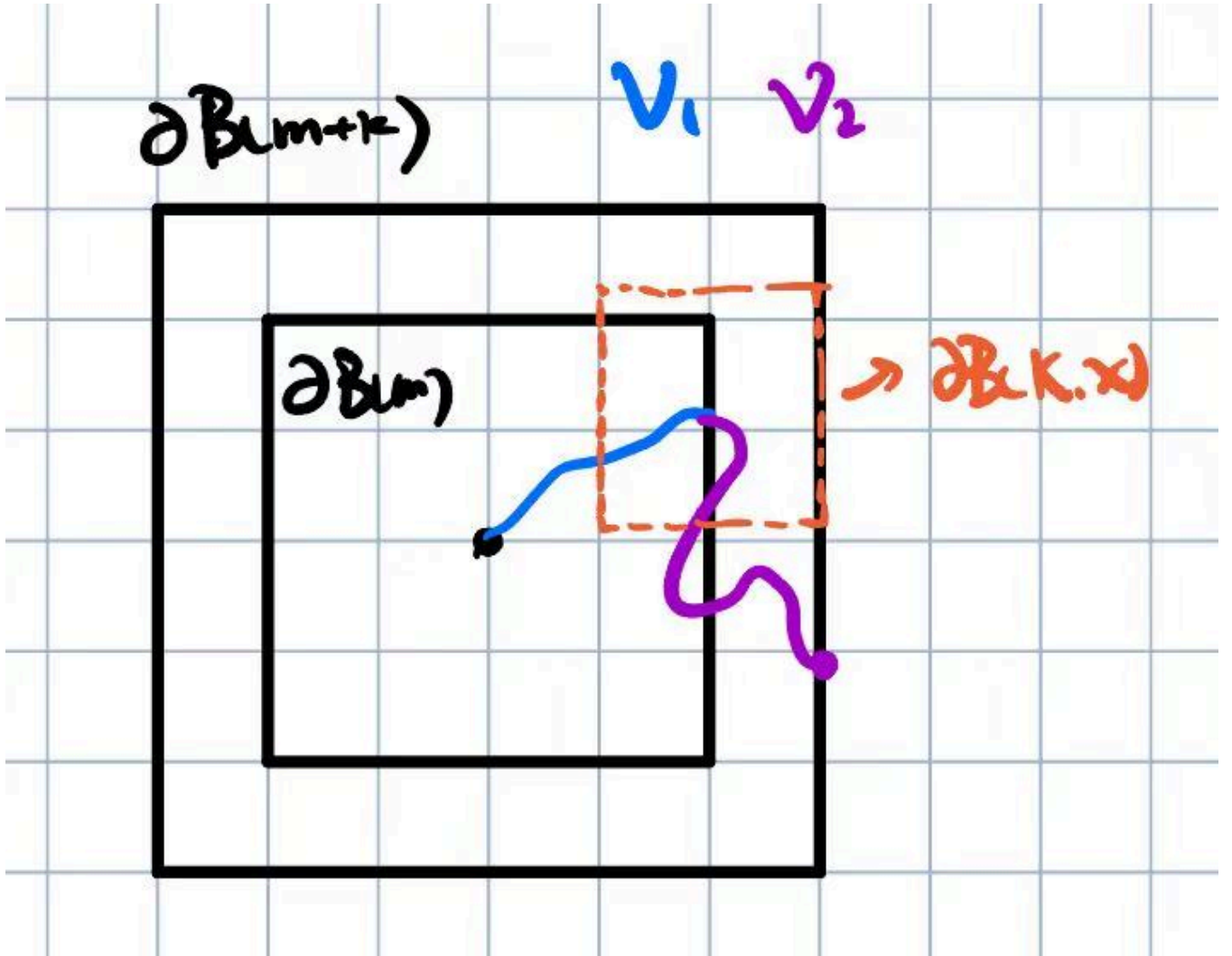
Let N be number of vertices in the open cluster containing origin O .

Suppose $\mathbb{E}N < \infty$, then $\mathbb{P}(O \leftrightarrow x) \leq e^{-c|x|}$ for some constant $c > 0$

A sketch of the proof

We have

$$O \leftrightarrow \partial B(m+k) \subseteq \bigcup_{x \in \partial B(m)} (O \leftrightarrow x) \circ (x \leftrightarrow \partial B(k, x))$$



Notice: We can require the path to be self-avoiding, and γ_1 and γ_2 not to be intersect. This assures "occur disjointly".

By BKR Inequality, we have

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbb{P}(O \leftrightarrow \partial B(m+k)) &\leq \sum_{x \in \partial B(m)} \mathbb{P}((O \leftrightarrow x) \circ (x \leftrightarrow \partial B(k, x))) \\
 &\leq \sum_{x \in \partial B(m)} \mathbb{P}(O \leftrightarrow x) \mathbb{P}(x \leftrightarrow \partial B(k, x)) \\
 &= \sum_{x \in \partial B(m)} \mathbb{P}(O \leftrightarrow x) \mathbb{P}(O \leftrightarrow \partial B(k)) \\
 &= P(O \leftrightarrow \partial B(k)) \mathbb{E} N_m
 \end{aligned}$$

where N_m is the number of nodes of $\partial B(n)$ to which the origin is connected.

Thus we can easily derive exponential decaying.